interviews with old comrades, and setting out ‘to collect old material from government files’[7] Comrade Ram Chandra finally published his indispensable account, covering everything from early days at the National College in Lahore with Bhagat Singh, right down to his execution, and beyond to when Subhas Chandra Bose sided himself with the Axis countries against the British in the Second World War. Others, however, take the view that whatever the genesis of the Sabha, Bhagat Singh was instrumental in actually turning it into the force that it eventually became and that it was a young Bhagat Singh aged nineteen who actually started the Naujawan Bharat Sabha (Youth Society of India) in 1926 and that it was his creation in the way in which we have come to understand it. In the words of Simona Sawhney, he had been, ‘[i]nspired, like many of his contemporaries, by Giuseppe Mazzini’s Young Italy Movement (1831)’[8] in doing so. The purpose of the Naujawan Bharat Sabha was to bring the youth of Punjab together under the umbrella of a new socialist non-religious organization. Socialism and humanism were thus amalgamated with nationalism. It is this which Bhagat Singh championed. It is this syncretism that made him so distinct from other leaders of the revolutionary movement. Others such as Mittal and Habib have explained how ‘[t]he *Naujawan Bharat Sabha* was formed to channelize the militant nationalist movement on ideological lines in March 1926 by Bhagat Singh’, with a ‘wider perspective’ so that whilst ‘it believed in the freedom of other enslaved nations also’,[9] the fact was that ‘[t]he Sabha also stood for secularism’.[10]